

Noble Tārā's Own Pledge Dhāraṇī

Ārya-Tārā-sva-pratijñā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 730 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་མ་སྒྲོལ་མ་རང་གསེང་མ་བཅས་བ་ཅས་བ་བྱའ་གཟུངས

Toh 730 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Tārā-sva-pratijñā-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as "Noble Tārā's Own Pledge," which may be rendered into English as "The Dhāraṇī Called Noble Tārā's Own Pledge." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and consists of a short but potent series of mantra syllables presented as a sacred commitment or vow of the bodhisattva Tārā herself. The text centers on the protective and liberating power of Tārā, promising that even the mere mental recollection of this dhāraṇī mantra is sufficient to dispel fears and bring about spiritual attainments. As is characteristic of dhāraṇī literature, the work is devotional and practical in orientation, invoking Tārā's vow to aid beings and situating her within the broader Mahāyāna framework of compassionate bodhisattva activity.

Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Sarva-duṣṭa-stambhanī tāre svāhā. The dhāraṇī of noble Tārā is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-Tārā-sva-pratijñā-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called "Noble Tārā's Own Pledge."

Homage to noble Tārā.

Then the dhāraṇī of Tārā's own pledge was spoken:

Tadyathā. Oṃ tāre tārāye. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Samayasthite. Bhara bhara. Sarvābharaṇa. Vibhūṣite. Padmani padma. Mahāpadma. Āsanasthite. Hasa hasa. Trailokya-varade. Sarva-deva-dāna-pa. Pūjite smadāhi. Bhagavatī tāre. Smarāhi. Bhagavāṃta. Tathāgatasya. Purataḥ samayaṃ. Dhara dhara. Mahāsattva-avalokite. Maṇi-kanika. Vicitrābharaṇe. Oṃ vilokāya. Che-ge-mo. Bhagavate tāre. Hrīṃ hrīṃ hrīṃ phaṭ svāhā.

By merely recollecting this dhāraṇī mantra in one's mind, all fears will be dispelled. All spiritual attainments (siddhi) will be obtained. All sentient beings will come under one's sway.

On the eighth or fifteenth day of the white fortnight, one should make great offerings to noble Tārā and recite the mantra continuously until Tārā appears directly before one in person. Whatever one desires will be granted. All supreme attainments will be bestowed. If she does not grant them, I myself

have committed the five acts of immediate retribution. Furthermore, immeasurable benefit will arise.

Vajra —

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "Che-ge-mo" within the mantra body is a Tibetan honorific interpolation meaning "great lady" or "sublime one," inserted directly into the Sanskrit dhāraṇī sequence rather than as a translation gloss. This is a recognized feature of some Tibetan dhāraṇī texts and has been left as it appears in the original.

The closing declaration "If she does not grant them, I myself have committed the five acts of immediate retribution" is a bold rhetorical vow formula in the first person, presented as the words of Tārā herself pledging to fulfill the mantra's promises. The five acts of immediate retribution (ānantarya-karma) are the gravest possible offenses in Buddhist ethics, so invoking them here is the strongest possible guarantee of efficacy.

The text breaks off mid-phrase at "Vajra," indicating this is a fragment and the passage continues beyond what was provided.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.